

G.L.O.S.S.A.R.Y

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Overview

The elevator Pitch

A symbolic roguelike deckbuilder where you climb a fractured Tower of Babel, mastering living runes and rewriting reality itself to ascend from an unnamed Shadow to Godhood.

Project Description (Detailed)

G.L.O.S.S.A.R.Y is a 2D roguelike deckbuilder RPG set inside a mythic, distorted version of the Tower of Babel. The player assumes the role of The Shadow — an undefined being seeking identity through ascension. Reality destabilizes as the player climbs higher, causing the core attack mechanic to malfunction unless properly identified and recorded in the Glossary system (A Glossary that contains Silhouettes of anything in the tower, as you climb you identify them); the ambient also is affected, but this is purely artistic value.

The core gameplay revolves around constructing attacks by using runes in chains in a turn-based combat. Players draw 7 runes each turn and combine them to create powerful effects. Identified runes become more reliable and efficient, while unidentified ones may fail — the higher the floor, the more they tend to fail.

Each run consists of seven floors, each representing a deeper break from reality. The player chooses a Covenant that defines their philosophy and playstyle — recursion, domination, or sacrifice. The run ends either in ascension to godhood or death and reset.

Progression is entirely knowledge-based. The Glossary records symbols, enemies, relics, bosses, and chains discovered. Death resets all the Player knowledge, but the Glossary still will contain all the things in the game, but now they will reset to be Undefined again (Silhouette).

Theme / Setting / Genre

- **Theme (Type of Game):** It's a search for Identity through knowledge and ascension as a Roguelike Deckbuilder with a turn-based combat.
- **Setting:** A mythological interpretation of ancient Mesopotamian Babel, structured as a seven-floor tower. The higher floors become increasingly abstract and distorted, visually glitching and breaking reality rules.
- **Genre:** Roguelike / Deckbuilder / Turn-Based Strategy RPG / Exploration

Core Gameplay Mechanics Brief

The player will climb floors, identify runes, use them in combat as chains of attack, defeat enemies, and attempt ascension while tied to a Covenant that provides a .

- **Runic Chain Construction Combat System**
- **Glossary Identification & Knowledge System**
- **Covenant Selection**

Targeted platforms

- PC

PC is ideal, as the majority of game consumers of the genre (roguelike) tend to come from this platform due to previous games of the same genre. (Keyboard/Mouse allows more complex/fluid movement system)

Monetization model (Brief/Document)

- **Premium Model** - One-time purchase. No microtransactions.

Project Scope

Cost: Minimal financial cost – Mainly due to possible Licenses for IDEA (Programming) or Assets (in case of use).

Time Scale: 2-3 Months

Core Team:

- Jessé R. Rogério
 - Game Design (Core Mechanism/Turn based Mechanics/Etc...)
 - Documentation
 - 2D Art Design (Characters Design/Environments Design/Texture)
 - Sound Design (Ambient Sounds/Combat Sounds/Boss Theme/SFX)

Licenses / Hardware / Other Costs:

- IntelliJ Idea 2022.3
- Personal PC (Playtesting)

Influences (Brief)

- Slay The Spire
 - Games

- Floor Progression/Deckbuilder Design/Turn Based.



- Tunic

- Games

- The hidden knowledge system and manual-based discovery inspire the Glossary mechanic and player-driven understanding.



- The Epic Of Gilgamesh

- Literature

- Themes of Mortality, divinity, ascension are taken as a heavy inspiration.

- The Tower of Babel

- Literature

- The concept of floor progression/fracturing of knowledge/language comes from here and is used in the game as you climb the tower becomes more and more undefined.

What sets this project apart from other games?

- Progression is Tied to Knowledge (The more you Explore the Easier the Game)
- Unique Fighting Style that rewards exploration.

Story and Gameplay

Story (Brief)

An unnamed Shadow climbs a collapsing Tower, building rune chains in combat and stabilizing knowledge in his Glossary. To ascend and define himself, he must confront his Covenant and achieve godhood.

Story (Detailed)

The Shadow has no origin. No memory of birth. No creator. It awakens at the base of the fractured Tower — a monument once built to reach divinity, now splintered across seven ascending layers of collapsing reality. The Tower is not merely stone and brick; it is the architecture of language itself. Every wall is inscribed with symbols that once defined existence.

The Shadow begins as undefined potential. It cannot speak, but it can perceive symbols. It cannot remember, but it can record. The only stable object in this unraveling structure is the Glossary — a physical archive being carried by the protagonist that binds symbols into understanding. What is identified becomes stable and reliable.

As the Shadow ascends, reality destabilizes. Lower floors resemble ancient Mesopotamian stone architecture — torches burn, walls stand firm, enemies bleed. But with each higher level, certainty erodes. Symbols flicker. Runes misfire. Geometry distorts. Enemies behave unpredictably, as if half-written into existence. Language begins to fracture.

The beings encountered within Babel are not monsters in the traditional sense — they are failed ascensions. Scholars who tried to interpret divine symbols and became hollow. Cultists who bound themselves to meaning too vast to contain. Golems carved with incomplete runes that animate through corrupted syntax. Wisps of abandoned concepts, drifting aimless and in search of definition. (And many more)

Early in the ascent, the Shadow must choose a Covenant — not an alliance, but a philosophy. Coil, Crown, or Ash. Recursion, Dominance, or Sacrifice. This choice does not grant morality; it grants perspective. The Covenant shapes how the Shadow interprets symbols, how it bends language, and how it defines power. Through this philosophy, the Shadow begins to take shape. Yet the Covenant is not merely guidance. It is a lens — and a cage.

As floors pass, the Glossary fills. Symbols once unstable become clear. Runes gain meaning. Enemies once incomprehensible become readable patterns. The Shadow grows not through strength, but through comprehension, the floors become strange, unnatural architecture, strange writings, a glitchy atmosphere and abandoned settlements are found, all forgotten.

At the summit manifests the “Conceptual Boss” - A Shadowy version of the Covenant the Shadow chooses. If the Shadow follows Coil, it faces infinite recursion. If Crown, it faces absolute authority. If Ash, it faces total annihilation.

The final battle is not for survival, but for definition. If victorious, the Shadow stabilizes its accumulated meaning and ascends. It ceases to be undefined. It becomes something — a God not by birth, but by comprehension.

If defeated, the Shadow dissolves into the symbolic corpse pile beneath Babel — another failed run. The Tower resets. Reality fractures anew. The climb begins again.

But the Glossary remembers.

Gameplay (Brief)

Climb floors, construct rune chains in combat, stabilize knowledge in your Glossary with found runes, build synergy through items and defeat the final boss.

Gameplay (Detailed)

Each run begins at the base of the Tower and progresses upward through seven floors. Every floor is structured as a node-based exploration map containing combat encounters, rune discoveries, relic rewards, Covenant interactions, and rare events. The player chooses paths between nodes, managing risk versus reward while attempting to gather powerful Runes and stabilize knowledge before higher floors increase instability.

Exploration directly feeds combat strength. Runes found in the Tower appear as undefined symbols. Interacting with them triggers an identification battle. Winning the battle stabilizes the Rune and permanently reveals its Translation for the remainder of the run. If the player loses, they lose 1 Life (Out of 3) and must continue without stabilizing that Rune. As floors increase, unidentified Runes gain higher failure chances, making early identification strategically valuable.

Combat is fully turn-based and built around the Rune Chain system. At the start of each player turn:

- The player draws up to 7 Runes
- The player may construct one linear Chain using 1–7 Runes.
- Order determines outcome, going left to right.

Each Rune has a defined Translation (e.g., Strength increases damage, Pierce ignores defense, Echo repeats a previous effect, etc.). Earlier Runes modify the outcome of later Runes. Once confirmed, the Chain executes completely unless interrupted by a status condition. After execution, the enemy performs its action.

Gameplay Flow:

- The player constructs a Chain.
- Chain resolves fully
- Enemy acts.

- Status Attacks (Rare)
- Normal Attacks
- Special Attacks (Boss Only)

Unidentified Runes introduce risk. On early floors, failure chances are low. On higher floors, instability increases significantly. Failure may result in:

- The Rune failing to activate.
- Reduced effect.

Identified Runes:

- Never fail.
- Operate at full strength (Stronger than undefined).
- Improve Chain Attacks

This makes the game reward progression; At the beginning of each run, the player selects one Covenant:

- **Coil (Recursion)** — Currency: Echoes
- **Crown (Dominance)** — Currency: Blood/Sacrifice
- **Ash (Sacrifice)** — Currency: Fire

Each Covenant provides:

- A unique resource currency.
- One powerful active ability.

Currency is generated through gameplay behaviors:

- Echoes are gained by identifying symbols.
- Blood is gained through sacrificial or decisive kills
- Fire is gained through enemy defeat or destructive actions.

During combat, once sufficient currency is accumulated, the Covenant ability may be activated during the player's turn. This does not replace the Rune Chain but enhances strategic flexibility (rewind turn, command enemy, or revive depending on Covenant). Only one Covenant can be chosen per run, shaping overall strategy.

Throughout the climb, players acquire relics that modify gameplay systems. Relics may:

- Alter Rune behavior
- Increase hand efficiency.
- Amplify covenant currency generation

- Improve rune efficiency

The player may equip up to three active relics at once. Each relic provides strong effects but often includes trade-offs, encouraging build specialization. Relics synergize with Rune Chains and Covenants, allowing multiple viable build paths across runs.

In **Multiplayer** mode, two players go through the floors together.

- Each player becomes the Conceptual Boss for the other at the end
- One wins other loses

Upon death:

- All Resets (No knowledge), the Glossary is reset (Only Shows the Dark Silhouettes)

Core Gameplay Mechanics (Detailed)

- Rune Chain Construction (Attack System)

Details: The player may perform only one attack (one Chain) per turn. A maximum of 7 Runes can be held in hand and up to 7 Runes can be placed in a linear Chain. Each Rune has a “Translation” that defines its effect (e.g., Strength increases attack power). Order is essential, as effects resolve from left to right. There are no branching paths.

The player always acts first, then the enemy. Chains cannot be interrupted except by status effects that interfere with execution.

How it Works: At the start of the turn, the player draws Runes (up to a 7 Rune hand). The player selects 1–7 Runes and arranges them in order. Once confirmed, the Chain resolves from left to right, applying each Rune’s Translation based on its position. After the Chain resolves, used Runes are discarded and the enemy performs its turn.

- Glossary Identification System

Details: Unidentified Runes are found on the map. Interacting with one triggers a battle. If the player wins, the Rune becomes Identified. If the player loses, they lose 1 Life. Identified Runes become stable and gain stronger effects.

On later floors, unidentified Runes may fail or behave inconsistently. Identified Runes do not fail and function at full strength.

How it Works: Unidentified Runes have a chance to fail during combat, with failure chances increasing on higher floors. Once identified, their Translation is permanently revealed and recorded in the Glossary, unless the Player dies, causing their loss of knowledge.

- Covenant Selection

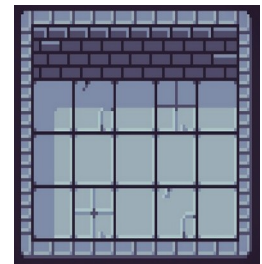
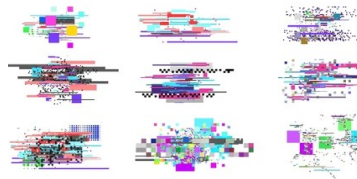
Details: At the start of a run, the player selects one Covenant. Each Covenant grants a unique currency and one ability that consumes that currency. The abilities are:

- Rewind
- Command Enemy (turn enemy into temporary ally)
- Revive

How it Works: The Covenant currency is generated through gameplay actions. When enough currency is available, the player may activate the Covenant ability during their turn. Only one Covenant can be chosen per run. Blood/Echoes/Fire are the currencies. Echoes - Acquired by identifying things, fire by killing enemies and blood by sacrificial kills or sacrificial knowledge.

Graphic style

- Glowing Runes
- Glitchy Distortions
- Dungeon Stone Architecture
- Dark Lighting
- Pixel Art
- Top Down



Assets Needed

- 2D

- Textures
 - Environment Textures
 - Stone Tile (Cracked Tile, Runic Pattern Tile, Edge Tile, Shifted Tile, Rocky

Tile)

- Stone Wall (Cracked Wall, Carved Wall, Wrap Around Wall)
- Stone Column (Broken Column, Wood Column, Big Column)
- Monolith (Big Monolith, Small Monoliths [Ritualistic])
- Stone Staircase (Broken Staircase, Side View Staircase, Forwards Staircase)
- Railing (Broken Railing, Closing Railing, Corner Railing)
- Hanging Chains (Broken Chain, Rusted Chain)
- Rocks
- Vines
- Mushrooms

- Fireflies
- Archway (Broken)
- Abandoned Campsite (Tent, Campfire) - [For Merchant NPC]
- Torch (Flame Off/On, Holder of Torch)
- Runes (Glowing - Different colors - one for each main floor)
- Flag
- Etc...

- Logos
 - Favicon/App Icon
- HUD
 - Achievements Page
 - Settings Page
 - Help Page
- Characters List
 - Shadow (Protagonist)
 - Merchant (Helper NPC)

Enemies:

- Green Slime
- Blue Slime
- Stone Golem
- Runic Golem
- Hooded Cultist
- Zealous Cultist
- Faint Wisp
- Soul Wisp
- Dungeon Scavenger
- Carrion Stalker
- Etc...

- Environmental Art Lists
- # 4 Maps TODO
 - Biome 1 (Lower Babel - Floors 1-2)
 - Biome 2 (Abandoned Babel - Floors 3-4)
 - Biome 3 (Mechanical Babel - Floors 5-6)
 - Biome 4 (Summit - Floors 7)

- Sound

- Sound List (Ambient)
 - Inside (There's no Outside - All Inside Tower)
 - Level 1 (Floors 1-2)

- Dungeon Theme/Dark/Water Droplets/Winds
- Level 2 (Floors 3-4)
 - Rainy/Puddles/Winds/Birds
- Level 3 (Floors 5-6)
 - Mechanical/Grinding/Pumps/Geysers/Fumaroles/Hot Water
- Level 4 (Floor 7)
 - Boss Theme (3) -> Coil/Ash/Crown

- Sound List (Player)

- Character Movement Sound List
 - Example 1
 - Example 2
 - etc.
- Character Hit / Collision Sound list
 - Example 1
 - Example 2
 - etc.
- Character on Injured / Death sound list
 - Example 1
 - Example 2
 - etc.

- Code

- Character Scripts (Player Pawn/Player Controller)
- Ambient Scripts (Runs in the background)
 - Example
- NPC Scripts
 - Example
 - etc.

- Animation

- Environment Animations
 - Example
 - etc.
- Character Animations
 - Player
 - Example
 - etc.
 - NPC

- Example
- etc.

Schedule and Milestones

You are welcome to start his game now and work on it over summer. You will make this game.

- <Objective #1>

- Time Scale / when complete?
 - Milestone 1
 - Milestone 2
 - Etc.

- <Objective #2> Minimum Viable Product (MVP)

- Time Scale / when complete?
 - Milestone 1
 - Milestone 2
 - Etc.

- <Objective #3> Alpha version

- Time Scale / when complete?
 - Milestone 1
 - Milestone 2
 - Etc.

- <Objective #4> Beta version

- Time Scale / when complete?
 - Milestone 1
 - Milestone 2
 - Etc.

- <Objective #5> Complete

- Time Scale / when complete?